standpoint as compared to the others. We are starting to build a community now and we hope to see a good future.

Q Which of the available devices is your closest competition?

The one I would find interesting would be with a high performance. So, I can think of three classes of competitors. First, the devices that are priced around $60-70 are generally based on Chinese APIs. I don't find them better because they are more expensive than ours. Then there are devices which are much more expensive than ours and better in performance, like the Beagleboard. It is three to four times more expensive than the Raspberry Pi. The one that I really find interesting is Odroid, which is priced at around $130. It is powered by an Exynos4412 Cortex-A9 Quad Core processor. It is an interesting device because it does things we can't do, unlike the other devices we are competing with.

Q How many pieces of Rasberry Pi do you aim to ship?

I think shipping 50,000 pieces of the device monthly would be fine but we aspire to reach the level of 100,000 pieces.

Q But if we look at the current demand for Raspberry Pi, you are not able to meet it. Why have shipments got delayed?

I think we are very close to meeting the demand and completing the orders. One of our two distributors made the Raspberry Pi delivery in August. So I think we are able to catch up with the demand. Very soon, we will be able to not only meet the demand but also create a back-up of the stock.

Q What features do you think are missing in Raspberry Pi just because it is a low-cost device?

The one feature that I think could have increased the adoption and popularity of Raspberry Pi is Wi-Fi. Regarding the rest of it, I think Raspberry Pi is a good package as compared to the others. We have good interfacing capabilities. It can have good accelerated multimedia capabilities, which many of these devices offer. Another thing that I really find missing in Raspberry Pi is a camera. If I ever go for a new interface, I would add a camera to it, for sure.

Q What is the Raspberry Pi summer code contest that you have announced?

This contest is for students. I think students should be taught coding not only to get into a job but to program their own machines. They should be given some incentives to get into programming. It is a high-frequency competition. The idea is to provide an opportunity where children are motivated to program. We want students from all parts of the world to participate in this and we are hopeful that we will see some very good apps coming out. The contest is just for students.

Q Can you provide the software details of Raspberry Pi?

Currently we run Debian Linux. Actually, we run a version of Debian Linux called Raspbian, which is customised for the Raspberry Pi. Raspbian introduces more comprehensive support for floating point operations. This is the result of an enormous amount of hard work by the team over the past couple of months and replaces the existing Debian squeeze image.

> This generation is not familiar with the programming bit. The root cause is the rise of home PCs and gaming consoles that have replaced the programming machines we used in the 1980s. We used machines like BBC Micros, Amigas and Spectrum ZX, with which we learnt how to program. I used to program on my own because those machines tempted me into programming.

Q Small-sized computers and low-cost tablets have become a rage. What is the minimum investment required to develop a proper computing device?

It is hard to develop a good computing device for less than $20. The money goes into a processor, which costs around $5; it goes into memory which costs around $4-5; into the PCB and a bunch of connectors which may cost around $5 and putting them together may cost another $5. So a computing machine cannot be made in less than $20.

Q How do you see India as a market for Raspberry Pi?

India is a really important market for a device like Raspberry Pi. Indians have recently shown a lot of interest in low-cost computing devices and Raspberry Pi can be a great alternative for those who want to have a good computing device. Not only in India, but in all the developing nations where computing amongst students is still to be made popular. We have kept such a low price-point only to make the device popular amongst the students and to encourage programming amongst them. I am sure Indian students will like the product.

Q Do you plan to join hands with the Indian government to take the product to schools?

We have not gone ahead to discuss this so far. But the Raspberry Pi Foundation would not mind if the government in India finds our device exciting enough to give it to their students. We are open to work on such lines. END